PowerScale Admin Assistant

An AI helper embedded in the OneFS WebUI and InsightIQ — grounded in Dell's own documentation, running entirely on the cluster.

THE PROBLEM

At 2 a.m., an admin mid-change has two bad options: search a 900-page manual, or open a support case and wait hours. Our working estimate is that **roughly 1 in 5 support contacts** are “how do I…” questions the documentation already answers — slow for the customer, and a cost to us for answering what we've already written down.

WHAT WE BUILT — A WORKING PROTOTYPE

An assistant inside the two consoles admins already use. Same engine, two scopes:

- OneFS WebUI — administration and configuration questions.
- InsightIQ — performance answers and “explain this alert.”

Ask in plain English and get numbered steps, the exact `isi` CLI command as a one-click copy, and a citation back to the guide it came from. Ask a performance question in the WebUI and it doesn't bluff — it hands you to InsightIQ.

WHY IT IS SAFE TO PUT IN FRONT OF CUSTOMERS

Grounded	Cited	100% local
Answers only from official docs. Says “I don't know” instead of inventing.	Every answer shows the source guide it came from.	Nothing leaves the cluster — unlocks federal and regulated accounts.

The knowledge base ships and stays current with each OneFS release, and the assistant suggests — it never executes.

IT RUNS WHERE THE PRODUCT RUNS

The assistant is CPU-based, like a PowerScale node. The prototype runs on a laptop; a node is Xeon-class, with the AI instructions and core count a laptop does not have — projecting answers in seconds on-node. A one-command bench is included to confirm it on real hardware.

STATUS AND THE ASK

- Today — grounded, cited answers in both consoles: proven. Cluster data in the demo is mocked.
- Next — connect to live cluster data so it answers about this cluster, not just the manual; then guarded, confirm-before-run actions.

The ask: green-light validation of the live-data step on a real node. The software is proven; it needs the cluster behind it.

Prototype — read-only; no live cluster calls. The 1-in-5 figure is a working internal estimate, to be validated against the support-ticket taxonomy.